

The basic features found in most CPIMC (besides supporting Yahoo!, MSN, ICQ, AIM, etc.) are:

- The ability to import contact lists, so you need not create the list all over again
- Various privacy options, for example, to remain invisible or ban certain users from sending IMs to you
- The ability to transfer files
- Keeping you updated about e-mails in the Inbox of each account
- Voice chat in addition to text chat

5.7.1 Miranda

(www.miranda-im.org/)

This open source CPIMC uses the Firefox mode of distribution, with a basic IM client forming the base download, and a host of plugins available to extend capabilities. It has been built with portability in mind, and doesn't require any installation. The base download supports AIM, ICQ, Yahoo!, MSN, IRC, and Jabber. If needed, more networks can



The Miranda window

be added by appending a plugin from the existing 350 odd—including one that allows integrating with the Skype Network, and another that can let Miranda receive instant notifications for new mails in your Gmail account (but not chat over the Google Talk network). While voice chat across platforms is possible, video chat requires installation of an add-on, and can only be done between Miranda clients.

5.7.2 Instant-t

(instant-t.com)

This CPIMC supports the usual IM networks, and also adds its own eponymous network. You need to sign up to the Instant-t network before being able to use the client to connect to other networks.